WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital

LIECHTENSTEIN

Europe

Information current as of November 2026

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WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Vaduz	Capital and financial centre, home to the Government, the Financial Market Authority and banking groups such as LGT and VP Bank	Private banking, wealth and asset management, funds, insurance
Schaan	Largest industrial and commercial municipality, headquarters of Hilti, Ivoclar and Hilcona	Construction technology, dental and medical technology, food production
Balzers	Southern industrial base and headquarters of Oerlikon Balzers, a specialist in surface coatings	Precision engineering, coatings, advanced materials
Unterland (Eschen, Mauren, Ruggell)	Northern municipalities bordering Austria, with industrial and commercial areas	Mechanical engineering, light manufacturing, logistics
Rhine Valley region with Switzerland and Austria	Shared labour market: about 24,600 cross-border commuters, 60% from Switzerland and 36% from Austria, fill more than half of Liechtenstein's jobs	Industrial supply chains, research partnerships, business services
Nationwide digital-asset framework	The Token and TT Service Provider Act (TVTG) gives a legal framework for tokenised assets, alongside the EU's MiCA rules applied through the EEA	Tokenisation, digital-asset custody, fintech

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- The Liechtenstein Business location portal and the Ministry of Interior, Economy and Sport provide guidance on company formation, permits and location factors
- EEA membership since 1995, giving full access to the EU single market for goods, services, capital and financial-services passporting
- Customs union with Switzerland since 1923 and the Swiss franc as legal tender under the currency treaty, giving tariff-free access to the Swiss market
- A flat 12.5% corporate income tax, among the lowest in Western Europe, with no national debt and AAA ratings from S&P and Moody's
- Financial-services licensing by the Financial Market Authority (FMA) for banks, asset managers, funds, insurers and crypto-asset service providers, with EEA passporting
- Token and TT Service Provider Act (TVTG) registration for tokenisation and custody, now alongside MiCA authorisation, which has applied directly since June 2025

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Liechtenstein in November 2026 offers investors a rare combination: AAA-rated public finances, the Swiss franc and the Swiss customs area, and full access to the EU single market through the EEA. The government has no outstanding debt, ran a surplus of 2.8% of GDP in 2025 according to the IMF, and holds net financial assets the IMF estimates at more than 140% of GDP; S&P affirmed its AAA rating with a stable outlook in June 2026. The financial centre continues to grow: client assets of the 11 Liechtenstein banks rose 6.8% to CHF 538 billion at the end of 2025 and their result from ordinary activities rose 19.4%. Industry generates about 42% of value added, led by globally active groups such as Hilti, Ivoclar and Oerlikon Balzers, and the economy creates more jobs than it has residents, with about 43,600 people employed and a population of about 40,900.

Liechtenstein's main structural challenge is the exposure of its export-led industry to global trade conditions and a strong currency. GDP is estimated to have fallen by about 3% in 2025, a year marked by US tariffs, and goods exports outside Switzerland fell 4.9% to CHF 3.05 billion. The response is already working: a November 2025 agreement with the United States and Switzerland cut the tariff on Liechtenstein's goods to 15%, inflation of 0.3% in March 2026 keeps costs stable, and the IMF projects a return to growth of 0.5% in 2026 and 1.5% by 2028. Large fiscal reserves give the government room to support growth, invest in infrastructure and skills, and pursue its review of deeper European integration, while low unemployment of about 2% and a deep cross-border talent pool support investors in precision manufacturing, medical technology and financial services.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
US tariffs and export demand	The US takes about 14% of goods exports; tariffs contributed to a 2025 contraction and some products still face higher sectoral rates	The 15% framework agreed in November 2025 reduces exposure; diversify across EEA, Swiss and Asian markets and review tariff classifications
Strong Swiss franc	Safe-haven appreciation of the franc can squeeze exporters' margins	Very low inflation offsets part of the effect; use hedging and focus on high-value, less price-sensitive niches
Financial-centre reputation and AML standards	The IMF has recommended tighter AML/CFT supervision, including of trustees, and reputational risk remains a focus for the financial centre	MONEYVAL rated Liechtenstein among Europe's strongest performers in 2022; robust compliance and FMA engagement turn standards into a competitive advantage
Small domestic market and land	With about 40,900 residents and limited land, the domestic market and site availability are constrained	Use Liechtenstein as a base for EEA and Swiss markets; partner with existing industrial estates and landlords
Skills shortages and permits	The IMF notes skills shortages, and residence permits are limited	Recruit from the Swiss and Austrian commuter belt and plan permit applications early
Crypto regulatory transition	TVTG providers needed MiCA authorisation by 1 July 2026 to continue serving clients under the EU regime	Confirm licensing status of counterparties with the FMA; the dual TVTG and MiCA framework offers legal certainty for compliant firms
Data timeliness	National accounts are published with a long lag and estimates for 2025 vary, from flat growth to a 3% decline	Use Liechtenstein Institute nowcasts, IMF reviews and company data for planning

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Liechtenstein's risk profile is among the lowest in Europe: a stable constitutional monarchy with a coalition government in office since April 2025, AAA ratings, no national debt, net public financial assets of more than 140% of GDP and a well-capitalised banking sector. It is a member of the EEA, the UN and the WTO, an associate member of Schengen since 2011 and a member of the IMF since 2024, and it is not subject to sanctions or on the FATF grey list. The main issues are economic rather than political: an estimated 3% contraction in 2025 linked to US tariffs, the risk of renewed Swiss franc strength and the IMF's call for stronger oversight of non-bank financial

firms and trustees. These are well understood and manageable, and the government's fiscal reserves give it unusual capacity to respond. Investors in financial services should expect thorough know-your-customer and licensing requirements, which underpin the centre's reputation.

MARKET ACCESS

Liechtenstein combines membership of the European Economic Area, which it joined in 1995, with a customs and currency union with Switzerland dating from 1923. This gives companies access both to the EU single market of goods, services and capital, including passporting for financial services, and to the Swiss market without customs barriers, while EFTA's free trade agreements extend access to partners worldwide. Liechtenstein has been a WTO member since 1995. Its main export markets are Germany and Austria, which together took about 45% of goods exports in 2024, followed by the United States (about 14%), China and France. Located in the Rhine Valley between Switzerland and Austria, it relies on road and rail links through its two neighbours and on nearby Swiss and Austrian airports.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Government of Liechtenstein (Prime Minister Brigitte Haas)	The five-member coalition government took office in April 2025; the Prime Minister also holds the finance portfolio and has launched a review of European integration options	Primary reference point for strategic, fiscal and European policy
Ministry of Interior, Economy and Sport (Hubert Büchel)	Leads economic and location policy, permits and support for industry	Key counterpart for market entry, manufacturing and employment matters
Financial Market Authority (FMA)	Integrated regulator for banks, insurers, funds, asset managers and crypto-asset providers; there is no national central bank as the Swiss franc is used	Essential for any financial-services licence or digital-asset activity
Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Environment and Culture (Deputy Prime Minister Sabine Monauni)	Manages EEA, EFTA and Swiss relations and trade negotiations, including with the United States	Relevant for market access and trade-policy issues
Liechtenstein Chamber of Commerce and Industry (LCCI)	Represents the main industrial exporters, whose member companies employ more than 10,000 people in Liechtenstein	Gateway to industrial partners and supply-chain opportunities
Liechtenstein Bankers Association and the major banks (LGT, LLB, VP Bank)	The three largest banks employ about 8,600 people including foreign group companies and anchor the financial centre	Relevant for wealth management, funds and financial partnerships
Liechtenstein Institute	Independent research institute that publishes GDP estimates and economic analysis	Useful source of economic intelligence and policy dialogue

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

The Liechtenstein Chamber of Commerce and Industry and the Liechtenstein Bankers Association are the main business associations, representing the country's industrial exporters and its banks, and both work closely with government on location and regulatory policy. The Liechtenstein Business portal provides information on company formation, the business location and economic news, and the Financial Market Authority publishes guidance for applicants in financial services and digital assets. Many investors access Liechtenstein through the wider Rhine Valley economy, using Swiss and Austrian chambers, professional advisers and research partners across the border. Liechtenstein's membership of EFTA, the EEA and, since 2024, the IMF provides regular international reviews and a network of free trade agreements, supporting commercial relations with partners worldwide.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Liechtenstein suits investors seeking a highly stable, low-tax, AAA-rated base with access to both the EU and Swiss markets: private banks, asset managers and fund promoters using EEA passporting and a financial centre

with CHF 538 billion in client assets; precision engineering, construction-technology and medical-technology manufacturers serving European and global supply chains; fintech and tokenisation firms using the TVTG and MiCA frameworks; and family offices and holding structures that value long-term political continuity. Investors should be prepared for rigorous licensing, compliance and substance requirements and limited land and residence permits.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Define the market-access model
Decide whether the business will use EEA passporting, the Swiss customs area or both, and structure the entity accordingly.

STEP 2: Engage the FMA early on regulated activities
Hold pre-application discussions on banking, fund, asset-management, insurance or MiCA licences and expected substance.

STEP 3: Plan sites, permits and staffing
Identify premises in industrial or business areas, plan residence permits early and recruit from the Swiss and Austrian commuter belt.

STEP 4: Confirm tax and trade treatment
Model the 12.5% corporate tax position with local advisers and check US tariff rates for specific product lines.

STEP 5: Build local relationships
Connect with the Chamber of Commerce and Industry, the Bankers Association and leading companies to identify partners and suppliers.